

Comments for Planning Application DM2025/01591

Application Summary

Application Number: DM2025/01591

Address: Ambulance Station Dorset Road Belmont SM2 6JH

Proposal: Change of use from Sui Generis (Ambulance Station) to mixed use Classes F1 (Places of Worship) and F2 (Community Hub) involving the erection of a part one, part two storey front and side extension, increase in height to part of building and provision of cycle and refuse stores.

Case Officer: Polly Davidson

Customer Details

Name: Mrs Saba Ahmad

Address: 162 Sandy Lane Cheam SM2 7ES

Comment Details

Commenter Type:

Stance: Customer made comments in support of the Planning Application

Comment Reasons:

Comment: Planning Application DM2025/01591 - Letter of Support

Dear Sir/Madam,

I am writing to express my strong support for planning application DM2025/01591.

As a mother of three young children, this proposal would make a meaningful difference to our family.

We currently attend Basma at its existing location, particularly for Friday prayers, and I have consistently been impressed by how responsibly and thoughtfully it is managed. Prayer times are staggered to prevent overcrowding, services are well organised and there have been no noticeable issues with congestion or disruption. In my experience, Basma makes clear efforts to minimise impact on the surrounding area.

I understand that concerns are sometimes raised around traffic or noise with developments of this nature. However, based on our regular attendance, services are structured and time-limited, and the management actively works to ensure smooth arrival and departure. The proposed location, with improved accessibility, would in fact make attendance easier and more efficient for families like ours, including elderly relatives who help with childcare.

For our family, this development is about far more than convenience. We do not live near extended family, and having access to a local place of prayer provides a sense of belonging and stability that is deeply important. Research has consistently shown that when children grow up feeling connected to a community, it strengthens their confidence and sense of identity. This means that being able to practise our faith locally allows them to understand who they are, feel proud of their heritage and build friendships with peers who attend the same school (the Avenue Academy). Again research has consistently shown that such experiences shape self-esteem and

emotional resilience in ways that benefit not only our own children but the wider group of young people growing up in the area.

The new location would also greatly support our elderly parents, who often assist with school pick-ups and childcare. Easier access would allow them to facilitate prayers and remain actively involved in passing on family tradition across generations.

In my view, the proposal is appropriate in scale and design and would provide long-term social, cultural, and wellbeing benefits to many local families. I respectfully request that Sutton Council approves this application.